```
$person = array("Fred", 35, "Betty");
list($name, $age, $wife) = $person;
// $name is "Fred", $age is 35, $wife is "Betty"
```

If you have more values in the array than in the list(), the extra values are ignored:

```
$person = array("Fred", 35, "Betty");
list($name, $age) = $person;          // $name is "Fred", $age is 35
```

If you have more values in the list() than in the array, the extra values are set to NULL:

```
$values = array("hello", "world");
list($a, $b, $c) = $values;          // $a is "hello", $b is "world", $c is NULL
```

Two or more consecutive commas in the list() skip values in the array:

```
$values = range('a', 'e');              // use range to populate the array
list($m, , $n, , $o) = $values;         // $m is "a", $n is "c", $o is "e"
```

Slicing an Array

To extract only a subset of the array, use the array_slice() function:

$subset = array_slice(array, offset, length);

The array_slice() function returns a new array consisting of a consecutive series of values from the original array. The offset parameter identifies the initial element to copy (0 represents the first element in the array), and the length parameter identifies the number of values to copy. The new array has consecutive numeric keys starting at 0. *For example*:

```
$people = array("Tom", "Dick", "Harriet", "Brenda", "Jo");
$middle = array_slice($people, 2, 2); // $middle is array("Harriet", "Brenda")
```

It is generally only meaningful to use array_slice() on indexed arrays (i.e., those with consecutive integer indices starting at 0):

```
// this use of array_slice() makes no sense
$person = array('name' => "Fred", 'age' => 35, 'wife' => "Betty");
$subset = array_slice($person, 1, 2); // $subset is array(0 => 35, 1 => "Betty")
```

Combine array_slice() with list() to extract only some values to variables:

```
$order = array("Tom", "Dick", "Harriet", "Brenda", "Jo");
list($second, $third) = array_slice($order, 1, 2);
// $second is "Dick", $third is "Harriet"
```

Remember

The use of the list function is a common practice for picking up values from a database selection where only one row is returned. This would automatically load the data from the simple query into a series of local variables. Here is an example of selecting two opposing teams from a sports scheduling database:

$sql = "SELECT HomeTeam, AwayTeam FROM schedule WHERE Ident = 7";

$result = mysql_query($sql);

list($hometeam, $awayteam) = mysql_fetch_assoc($result);